AFRICAN INSTITUTE OF PROJECT ASSURANCE AND FORENSICS
AIPAF

CPFE Requirements

FORENSICS

Certified Project Forensic Examiner

The CPFE certifies competence to investigate a project that has failed, stalled, been abandoned, overrun, or fallen into dispute, and to establish, to a standard capable of surviving scrutiny, what happened, why, and what the avoidable loss amounts to.

1. Routes to certification

The Institute recognises three routes. All converge on the same examinations and the same standard. No route bypasses the foundation or its ethics component.

ROUTE	FOR WHOM	REQUIREMENT
Professional route	Established practitioners from cognate fields: engineering, surveying, audit, law, project management, forensic accounting.	A recognised professional qualification, plus a minimum of five years' relevant experience with at least two at a senior level, then the Institute's examinations.
Graduate route	Graduates in relevant disciplines entering the profession.	A relevant degree, plus a minimum of three years' structured and supervised experience logged against the track competencies, then the examinations.
Experience route	Skilled practitioners without a formal cognate qualification but with substantial demonstrable practice.	A minimum of eight years' relevant experience, a portfolio of work assessed by the Institute, then the full examination sequence.

> The stated minimum years are thresholds, not entitlements. Meeting the years does not by itself satisfy the requirement if the logged competencies are not demonstrated.

2. Shared foundation examinations

All three foundation papers must be passed before any CPFE paper is attempted. A candidate who has already passed the foundation for another AIPAF credential does not repeat it.

PAPER	FORMAT	DURATION	PASS MARK
F1 Principles of Project Delivery	Multiple choice and short written answer	3 hours	50%
F2 Evidence and Method	Written answer and a short analytical exercise	3 hours	50%
F3 Professional Ethics and Independence	Scenario-based written answer	2 hours	60%

3. CPFE examinations

After the foundation, the two written papers and the competency assessment may be attempted in any order.

ASSESSMENT	FORMAT	DURATION	PASS MARK
P1 Forensic Investigation and Analysis	Written answer and worked problems	3 hours	50%
P2 Delay, Quantum, and Expert Evidence	Written answer and case questions	3 hours	50%
C Competency Assessment	A forensic investigation and report on a set project case	Take-home	50%

4. Experience requirement

A candidate must evidence relevant forensic, dispute, or investigative experience, logged against the CPFE competencies and verified before certification. The experience must demonstrate independent investigation of project failure or dispute, conducted to an evidentiary standard.

Experience is logged against the published competencies and verified by the Institute, with reference to employers or clients where appropriate, before any credential is conferred.

5. Syllabus modules

- Principles of forensic investigation
- Root-cause analysis of project failure
- Forensic delay analysis
- Quantum and loss assessment
- Investigation of fraud and irregularity
- Evidence, documentation, and chain of custody
- Expert evidence and reporting
- Dispute resolution context

6. Examination regulations

- A mark of 70% or above is recorded as a distinction.
- A failed paper may be resat, with up to four attempts at any single paper.
- All examinations for the credential must be completed within five years of the first paper passed.
- Misconduct or misrepresentation may bar certification, and a credential obtained through it is withdrawn.

7. Keeping the credential: CPD

- A minimum of 35 hours of continuing professional development each year.
- At least 20 of those hours must be structured (courses, examined study, formal seminars or equivalent).
- Records are kept annually and a sample is audited. A credential not restored to good standing lapses.

> **Scope of the designation.** A holder does not investigate a project in which they hold a delivery interest.

Source: AIPAF Credential Specification and Examination Framework, Edition 2026. For enquiries contact info@aipafgh.org · www.aipafgh.org